



TOWN MODERATOR

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Statement on the 250th Anniversary of the American Revolutionary War

In our current practice of local participatory democracy, we maintain and renew a tradition of self-governance practiced for 400 years. By gathering together today, we honor and embrace the Town Meetings of 250 years ago. They were the local democracies that, by their nature, taught Americans the virtues and responsibilities of self-government. It was through the conduct of Town Meetings that the Colonial American public embraced the inalienable right of self-determination -- independent of the British Empire's control -- which, in turn, sparked a revolt and fueled a Revolution.

On June 20, 1776 Natick Town Meeting approved a "Declaration of Natick's 'Resolve for Independence'" drafted by Rev. Stephen Badger, Captain John Coolidge, and Daniel Morse IV in support of the Declaration of Independence, which included the opinion that "... the sooner it is come into the fewer difficulties we shall have to contend with, and the grand objects of peace, liberty, and safety, will be more likely speedily to be restored and established in our once happy land."

We also honor those soldiers from Natick who took part in the earliest battles of the Revolution. In 1775, both European and Indian citizens of Natick participated in the battles of Lexington, Concord and Bunker Hill, as well as serving in the Continental Army. The names of Natick's Praying Indian soldiers are memorialized along with all of Natick's Revolutionary War veterans on a stone marker on Pond Street, near downtown Natick.

The voices then raised, actions taken, financial support committed, and lives and liberties pledged in Natick and at many Town Meetings in the Commonwealth remain our worthy heritage.

Jeff Alderson, Town Moderator